Leeds Harvard for biblatex

A biblatex/Biber style for the University of Leeds **Leeds Harvard** referencing style. It follows the Library's guidance:

- Leeds Harvard referencing examples
- Journal article
- Common issues

The style doesn't depend on any engine. It gives the same output on **pdfLaTeX, XeLaTeX and LuaLaTeX**.

File	Purpose
`leeds-harvard.bbx`	Reference list (bibliography) style
`leeds-harvard.cbx`	In-text citation style (author–date)
`test.tex`	Demo document showing every citation command and entry type (uses `iftex` to load fonts safely on each engine)
`leeds-harvard-test.bib`	Fixtures copied from the Leeds guide's examples, used by `test.tex`
`test.pdf`	Pre-built output of `test.tex`

Usage

Put `leeds-harvard.bbx` and `leeds-harvard.cbx` next to your `.tex` file (or in your local `texmf` tree, or upload them to Overleaf). Then:

```
\usepackage[british]{babel}
\usepackage{csquotes}
\usepackage[style=leeds-harvard]{biblatex}
\addbibresource{references.bib}
...
\parencite{key}            % (Shannon, 1948)
\textcite{key}             % Shannon (1948)
\parencite[24]{key}        % (Shannon, 1948, p.24)
\parencite[20--29]{key}    % (Shannon, 1948, pp.20-29)
\parencite[iv]{key}        % (Dirac, 1958, iv)
\parencite{a,b}            % (MacNaughton et al., 1999; Ahmed and Meehan, 2012)
\parencite[Shannon, 1948, cited in][9]{tanenbaum} % (Shannon, 1948, cited in Tanenbaum, 2003, p.9)
\printbibliography             % automatically titled "References"
```

Compile with `<engine> → biber → <engine> → <engine>`.

Options

Option	Default	Effect
`no-place` (or `noplace`)	`false`	Omits `[no place]` when `location` is missing. Set to `true` (strict Leeds) to print `[no place]: Publisher`.
`hyphenranges`	`true`	Uses a hyphen in page and date ranges, as the guide does (`pp.652-669`). Set it to `false` for an en dash.
`url`, `doi`	`true`	Standard biblatex switches. Turn them off to hide `[Online]`, the access date and the link.

Option	Default	Effect
`uniquename`	`false`	Set to `init` to cite *(R.F. Jones, 1998)* when two authors share a surname.

Entering data

Leeds source type	Entry type / fields
Journal article	`@article`: `journaltitle`, `volume`, `number`, `pages`
Article number	`@article` with `eid` and no `pages` (or `eid` = `pages`, as ADS exports it) gives *article no: 25809 [no pagination]*
Supplement	`number = {Supp. 3}`
Pre-/post-print, forthcoming	`pubstate = {preprint}` / `{postprint}` / `{forthcoming}`
Newspaper	`@article` + `entrysubtype = {newspaper}`, full `date` (gives *24 May, p.1*)
Book / e-book	`@book`: `edition`, `series` + `number`, `editor`, `translator`, `location`, `publisher`
E-book reader	`howpublished = {Kindle DX e-book}` gives *[Kindle DX e-book]*
Edited book	`@collection` with `editor` gives *Wheeler, J.A. and Zurek, W.H. eds.*
Chapter in edited book	`@incollection`: `editor`, `booktitle`, `pages`
Conference paper	`@inproceedings`: `booktitle`, `eventdate`, `venue`
Thesis	`@thesis`, `type = {phdthesis}`, `institution`
Report / working paper	`@report`: `institution` or `publisher`, optional `type` + `number`
Website	`@online`
Blog post	`@online` with `maintitle` (the blog's name) and a full `date`
Dataset	`@dataset`: `publisher` (e.g. *Figshare*)
Software	`@software`: `version`
Unpublished	`@unpublished`
Corporate author	`author = {{Royal Academy of Engineering}}`
Corporate abbreviation	add `shortauthor = {NASA}`. The first citation gives *(National Aeronautics and Space Administration [NASA], 2011)*, later ones *(NASA, 2011)*
No author	`author = {Anon}`

The style adds these automatically:

- **[Online]**, *[Accessed D Month YYYY]* (from `urldate`) and *Available from:* whenever the entry has a `doi` or `url`. It prints `https://doi.org/…` in preference to the URL.
- **[no date]** in the reference list and *no date* in citations.
- **[no publisher]** for books when publisher is missing (or **[no place]: [no publisher]** if `no-place=true` is set). When publisher is present but `location` is omitted, the publisher alone is printed by default (no `[no place]`).
- **[no pagination]** for articles that have a volume or issue but no pages.

Enter titles in sentence case. The style doesn't change the case of titles.

Physics and astronomy: NASA ADS exports

You can paste BibTeX from the SAO/NASA Astrophysics Data System into your `.bib` file unchanged. The bibcode works as the citation key: `\parencite{2026ApJ..1008L..60C}` gives *(Chen et al., 2026)*. A source map in the style fixes

the rest as Biber reads the file:

ADS export	What the style does
`journal = {\apjl}`, `{\mnras}`, `{\aap}`, …	Prints the full journal title (*The Astrophysical Journal Letters*). Leeds Harvard doesn't allow abbreviated titles. You don't need `aas_macros.sty`.
`eid = {L60}`, `pages = {L60}`	*article no: L60 [no pagination]*, not *p.L60*
`doi`	Links to `https://doi.org/…`
No `doi`	Links to your own `url` (the publisher or journal page) if there is one. Otherwise it links to `adsurl` (the ADS abstract page).
`journal = {arXiv e-prints}`	Prints *[Pre-print]. … arXiv. [Online]. Available from: https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.1501.02297*. The arXiv DOI is built from `eprint` when ADS doesn't give one.

For example, the ADS record 2026ApJ..1008L..60C prints as:

> Chen, C., Armitage, P.J., Nixon, C.J., Lubow, S.H. and Martin, R.G. 2026. On the Formation of Retrograde S-type Planets in Binaries with a Polar Circumbinary Disk. *The Astrophysical Journal Letters*. [Online]. **1008**(2), article no: L60 [no pagination]. Available from: https://doi.org/10.3847/2041-8213/ae9d4d

To build the `.bib` straight from the bibcodes, arXiv IDs or DOIs used as keys in your `.tex`, you can use adstex (`adstex paper.tex -o refs.bib`).

ADS can't supply everything, so check these yourself:

- **Access date.** ADS has no `urldate`. Add `urldate = {YYYY-MM-DD}` with the date you actually read the item, and the style prints *[Accessed …]*.
- **Title case.** ADS locks title case with `"{…}"`. To follow the Leeds sentence-case examples, edit the title by hand. The style won't lower-case it for you, because that would break names like *S-type* and *AGN*.
- **Journals not on the list.** If ADS gives a journal macro the style doesn't know, LaTeX reports an undefined command. Replace it with the full title. See `\lh@adsjournals` in leeds-harvard.bbx for the list.
- **A&A** prints as *Astronomy and Astrophysics*, because an ampersand can't pass through Biber's control file. Write `journal = {Astronomy \& Astrophysics}` if you want the ampersand.

Trying the demo

```
pdflatex test; biber test; pdflatex test; pdflatex test
```

XeLaTeX and LuaLaTeX work the same way.

Where the output differs from individual guide examples

A few of the guide's examples don't match its own templates. In those cases the style follows the **template**:

Guide example	Style output	Why
`pp. S236-S242`	`pp.S236-S242`	Everywhere else the guide writes `pp.` with no space
`Bonacin, R., Nabuca, O.F., and Pierozzi, I.`	`…, Nabuco, O.F. and Pierozzi, I.`	No serial comma, as in every other example
Andersson Cederholm *et al.* e-book has no `[Online]`	`[Online]` included	The e-book template and the "Online items" rule both require it
Blog date `06 May`	`6 May`	Other dates in the guide (e.g. `3 April 2024`) have no leading zero

Guide example	Style output	Why
`paragraph?.`	`paragraph?`	biblatex doesn't add a full stop after ?
`Jones 1998a` = *How to write…*	`1998a` = *Advanced writing tips*	Biber gives same-author, same-year letters in title order

Citation order inside one bracket isn't sorted automatically (`sortcites=false`). The guide wants the oldest source first, so write keys in that order.

Beta Notice & Reporting Discrepancies (v0.1.0)

> **Important:** This package is currently in **v0.1.0 (Public Beta)**. While core entry types (`@article`, `@book`, `@incollection`, `@online`) match the University of Leeds Harvard specification, rare entry types and edge cases may still fall back to standard `biblatex-authoryear` behavior.

If you encounter formatting that differs from the official university library guidelines, please report it via the GitHub Issue Tracker.

To help us fix the issue quickly, please include: 1. **The `.bib` entry:** The exact BibTeX snippet causing the issue. 2. **Current output:** How the citation and bibliography entry currently render in your document. 3. **Expected output:** The exact text/punctuation required by the official Leeds Library Harvard guide. 4. **Reference link:** A direct link to the relevant section of the Leeds Harvard Referencing Guide.

Need an Immediate Fix for a Deadline? (Escape Hatch)

If a specific reference is not rendering according to Leeds guidelines and you need to submit immediately without waiting for a package update:

- **Override specific fields in your `.bib` file:**
  You can bypass field formatters by passing raw text or using curly braces:

```
@online{sample2026,
  author = {{World Health Organization}},
  title  = {Title of the Report},
  year   = {2026},
  note   = {[Online]. Available at: \url{https://...} [Accessed 14 May 2026]}
}
```